

Waterproof Temperature Sensor (DS18B20)

Hardware Overview

What is it?

The **DS18B20** is a highly accurate temperature sensor sealed inside a waterproof probe. It is suitable for measuring the temperature of liquids, soil, or harsh environments from -55°C to $+125^{\circ}\text{C}$.

Electrical Explanation

This sensor uses a communication protocol called *1-Wire*. Unlike I²C (which requires two data lines) 1-Wire allows the controller to communicate with the sensor using only *a single digital pin*.

- Wires: The sensor has 3 pins: **Black (GND/0V)**, **Red (Power/5V)**, and **Yellow (data wire, e.g. D8)** + $4.7\text{k}\Omega$ resistor connected to 5V.

 **The Pull-up Resistor** Because the single data wire must transmit data in both directions, it requires "help" to return to a "High" state. You MUST place a $4.7\text{k}\Omega$ resistor connecting the data wire and the 5V wire. If you forget this resistor, the sensor will never communicate!

Key Hardware Facts:

- **Connection:** Wired to a Digital Pin (e.g. D12).
- **Voltage:** Operates at 5V.
- **Signal Flow:** Ambient Heat → Waterproof Casing → Silicon Temperature Sensor → ADC → 1-Wire Data → Processor.

Software & Programming

kcomp_DS18B20.h

This library hides the timings of the *1-Wire* bus, allowing you to request and read temperature data.

Usage: `#include <kcomp_DS18B20.h>`

The Data Structure

Unlike other sensors that give you a single number (like `int`), the DS18B20 gives you a `struct` (a package of variables). When you call `getDS18B20Data()`, you get a package containing all of this:

Field	Type	Description
<code>is_valid</code>	<code>bool</code>	<code>true</code> if the temperature was successfully read and verified.
<code>temperature_c</code>	<code>float_t</code>	The temperature of the probe in $^{\circ}\text{C}$.

Function Reference

Function Name	Description & Parameters
<code>bool initDS18B20(uint8_t pin)</code>	Setup: Starts the <i>1-Wire</i> bus on a specific digital pin. ▪ Returns <code>true</code> if connected, <code>false</code> if missing.
<code>void requestDS18B20()</code>	Trigger: Wakes the sensor up and asks for the temperature.
<code>ds18b20_data_t readDS18B20()</code>	Read Data: Retrieves the data after a 750ms delay. If <code>is_valid</code> is <code>false</code> , it is still calculating.

⚠ Pitfalls & Troubleshooting

- **The Missing Resistor**

If you forget about the 4.7kΩ resistor, the sensor will not work.

The Fix: Simply do not forget about the 4.7kΩ resistor!

- **The "Highlander" Rule (There Can Be Only One!)**

To keep this library lightweight, it is designed as a "Singleton". It only supports one sensor.

The Problem: To make our library flat and easy to read, it uses a command called `SKIP_ROM (0xCC)`. This tells all sensors: *"I don't care what your ID is, everyone measure the temperature!"* Thus, if you use multiple sensors, they will corrupt the data.

The Fix: Stick to one DS18B20 thermometer per project!

- **Waterproof vs. Submersible**

The metal tip of the sensor is waterproof. However, the black heat-shrink is only *water-resistant*. If you submerge the entire wire and the heat-shrink in a pot of boiling water, the adhesive inside the tubing will melt, water will leak in, and the sensor will be destroyed.

The Fix: Only submerge the silver metal part in boiling hot water!

Sample Program

It takes the sensor about 750ms to calculate the temperature. Using `delay()` would block your program. We can do better: this code demonstrates a **non-blocking** loop!

```
#include <kcomp_DS18B20.h>

// We are connecting the Yellow Data wire to Digital Pin 12
#define TEMP_PIN 12

void setup() {
  Serial.begin(115200);
  delay(1000);

  Serial.println("K-Comp Thermometer Online");

  if (!initDS18B20(TEMP_PIN)) {
    Serial.println("DS18B20 not found! 4.7k resistor betw. 5V and DQ?");
    while(1);
  }

  requestDS18B20(); // Ask the sensor to start measuring
}

void loop() {
  // Check if the sensor has finished its 750ms calculation
  ds18b20_data_t temp_sensor = readDS18B20();

  if (temp_sensor.is_valid) {
    Serial.print("Temperature: ");
    Serial.print(temp_sensor.temperature_c); Serial.println(" °C");
    // Immediately ask it to start the NEXT measurement
    requestDS18B20();
  }
  // Your K-Comp is free to run other code without blocking!
}
```

💡 **Try it out:** You can find the full sample program `SimpleTemperatureSensorDS18B20` in the K-Comp examples folder!